# Tim Everard

## Head of Esports Operations

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### PROFILE

Esports and live events operations leader with 15 years' experience, from theatre lighting and TV studio builds to heading Esports Operations at BLAST. Led a six-person department delivering tournament and player operations across every BLAST title, including CS2, Dota 2, Rocket League and Fortnite. Across six years at BLAST that meant 60+ flagship events and 300+ qualifiers in 13 countries, 2,000+ freelancers and €12m+ in budgets. Hands-on across event management, freelancer booking and contracting, budgets and equipment, and built the department's own operations tools. Having worked every side of a live show, on the ground and in the office, I focus on making event day run smoothly for the people on site.

| 60+ | 300+ | 13 | 2,000+ | €12m+ |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| flagship esports events | qualifiers | countries | freelancers | in budgets |

### EXPERIENCE

**Head of Esports Operations** — Jun 2023 – Oct 2026
**BLAST**

- Led a six-person department running tournament operations across every BLAST ecosystem, including CS2, Dota 2, Brawl Stars, Fortnite, Rocket League and Rainbow Six
- Brought Team Operations into the department, so all online and offline player management and support sat with one team
- Rebuilt how the department works, with clearer ownership, accountability and proper documentation
- Designed and built the department's own tools for tournament operations, event and equipment tracking, freelancer calendars, bookings and contracting, and event budgets and deadlines
- Costed and pitched new tournament work with the product and commercial teams
- Wrote the business case for a departmental OPEX budget covering equipment renewal, software and cross-event costs
- Set technical requirements for commercial partnerships

### KEY SKILLS

**Operations leadership**
Team leadership, people management, restructuring, process improvement

**Event management**
Tournament and player operations, event logistics, site visits, bootcamps

**Freelancers and vendors**
Freelancer booking, contracting and payments, rotas, vendor management

**Commercial and finance**
Budgets, pitch costings, invoices, business cases, stakeholder management

**Systems and tooling**
Airtable, Google Workspace, Microsoft Office

**Broadcast and technical**
Studio builds, Blackmagic, vMix, Ross Video, lighting, audio, PAT testing

**Safeguarding and safety**
Designated Safeguarding Lead, first aider, fire marshal

### CERTIFICATIONS

| | |
|---|---|
| First Aid at Work | 2022 |
| Safeguarding Lead (DSL) | 2021 |
| Working at Heights | 2018 |
| Moving Head Maintenance | 2018 |
| Manual Handling | 2018 |
| Fire Marshal | 2018 |
| PAT Testing | 2016 |
| IPAF | 2012 |

### Tournament Operations Manager

Jan 2020 – Jun 2023

**BLAST** · Contractor to Mar 2021, then permanent

- Managed tournament equipment and staffing budgets across CS:GO, Dota 2, Apex Legends, FIFA, Fortnite and Rainbow Six
- Booked and managed tournament operations freelancers for internal, external and online productions
- Approved equipment and staffing invoices, and decided when to hire, buy or repair tournament kit
- Arranged venues and equipment for team bootcamps
- Main tournament-level contact for FACEIT, ESIC and BLAST Premier teams
- Designated Safeguarding Lead and first aider at live events

### Broadcast Freelancer

Jan 2018 – Jan 2020

**Self-employed** · Alongside Jam Television

- Crewed broadcasts and live events for clients including BLAST Pro Series, ESL UK and ESL Germany, BBC, Sky Sports, ITV, Immediate Media, NATS, Big Ben (WRC), Altitude Angles and Create Broadcasting
- Worked in the gallery as technical director, producer and graphics operator on live shows
- On-stage admin at esports events, and consulted on production and technical setups for clients

### Broadcast and Studio Manager

Mar 2018 – Jan 2019

**Jam Television** · Birmingham

- Designed a multi-camera TV studio from scratch, bought the equipment, and managed installation and testing
- Controlled the studio budget, including equipment purchasing
- Hired freelancers and ran staff rotas to keep a 24-hour TV channel on air, including holiday cover and emergency call-outs
- Trained staff on studio equipment and workflows
- Managed suppliers, invoice approval and day-to-day maintenance, including software and hardware updates

### Production Manager

Jul 2015 – Dec 2017

**ESL UK** · Leicester

- Built and set up the technical infrastructure for two ESL UK studios
- Managed production for both studios and at external events including MCM, EGX and Formula E
- Controlled production budgets and purchased studio and event equipment
- Worked in the gallery as technical director, producer and graphics operator on live broadcasts
- Hired freelance crew, managed rotas and supervised internal and external staff on live shows
- Trained crew on equipment and workflows, and ran equipment hire, installation, testing and maintenance

### Senior Lighting and Event Technician

Jun 2012 – Jun 2015

**Dorking Halls** · Casual Technician Mar 2010 – Jan 2011

- Controlled the equipment and training budget, and ran in-house lighting training
- Maintained specialist kit for a theatre and two cinemas, from lighting and audio desks to 35mm and digital projectors
- Carried out PAT testing on the venue's electrical equipment
- Covered whatever the show needed, working as audio engineer, stage hand or stage manager
- Set up and ran touring and in-house performances
- Head of lighting for The Darkness's support act, support lighting engineer for Enter Shikari, head of audio and lighting for Lee Mack, and comedy tours with Jimmy Carr, Dara Ó Briain and Ed Byrne